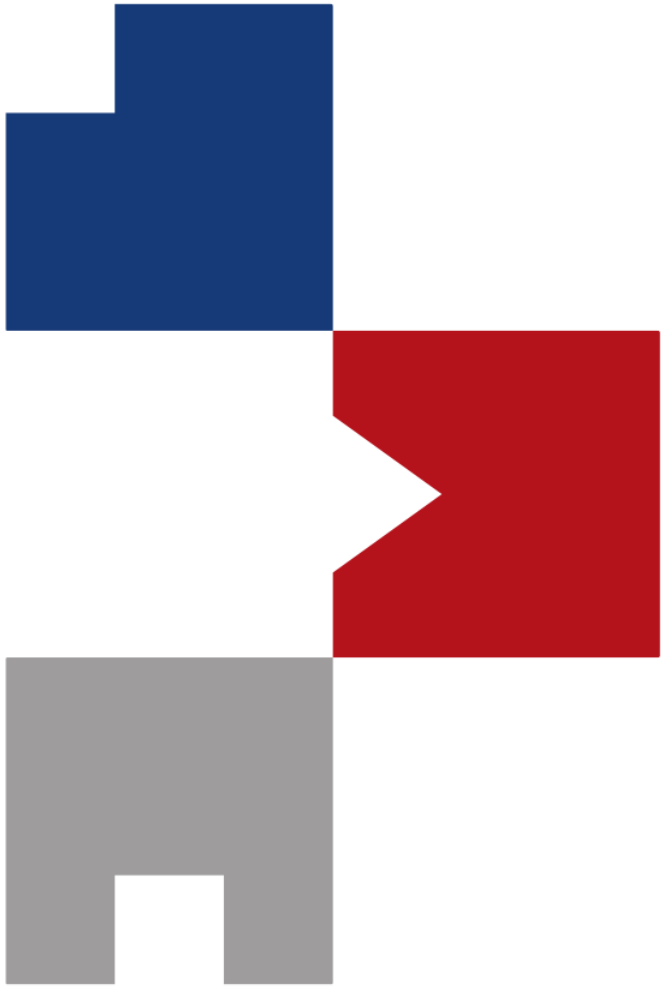
Note) Slides and example codes are available:
https://github.com/mint-lab/prog_meets_math



Python: Basic

Sunglok Choi, Assistant Professor, Ph.D.
Computer Science and Engineering Department, SEOULTECH
sunglok@seoultech.ac.kr | https://mint-lab.github.io/

Why Python?

- TIOBE Programming Community Index
  - Measure: The number of web pages (counted in Google, MSN, …, YouTube)
  - **Python** is in the first place (on September 12th, 2024).

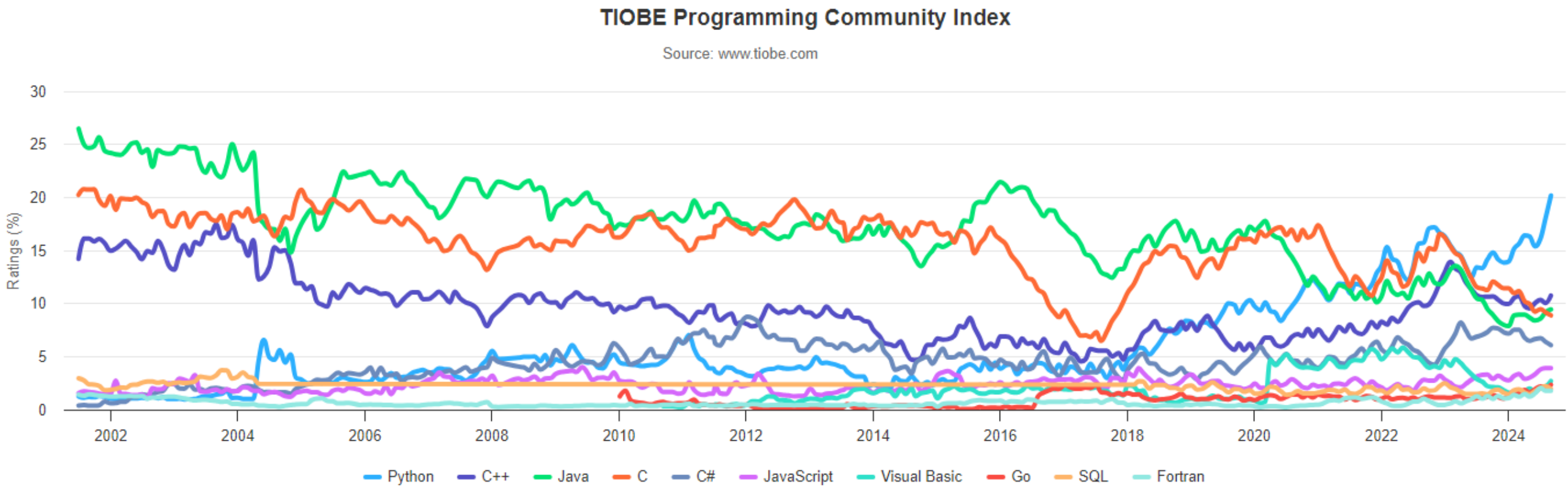


Image: TIOBE Programming Community Index (retrieved on September 12th, 2024)

Why Python?

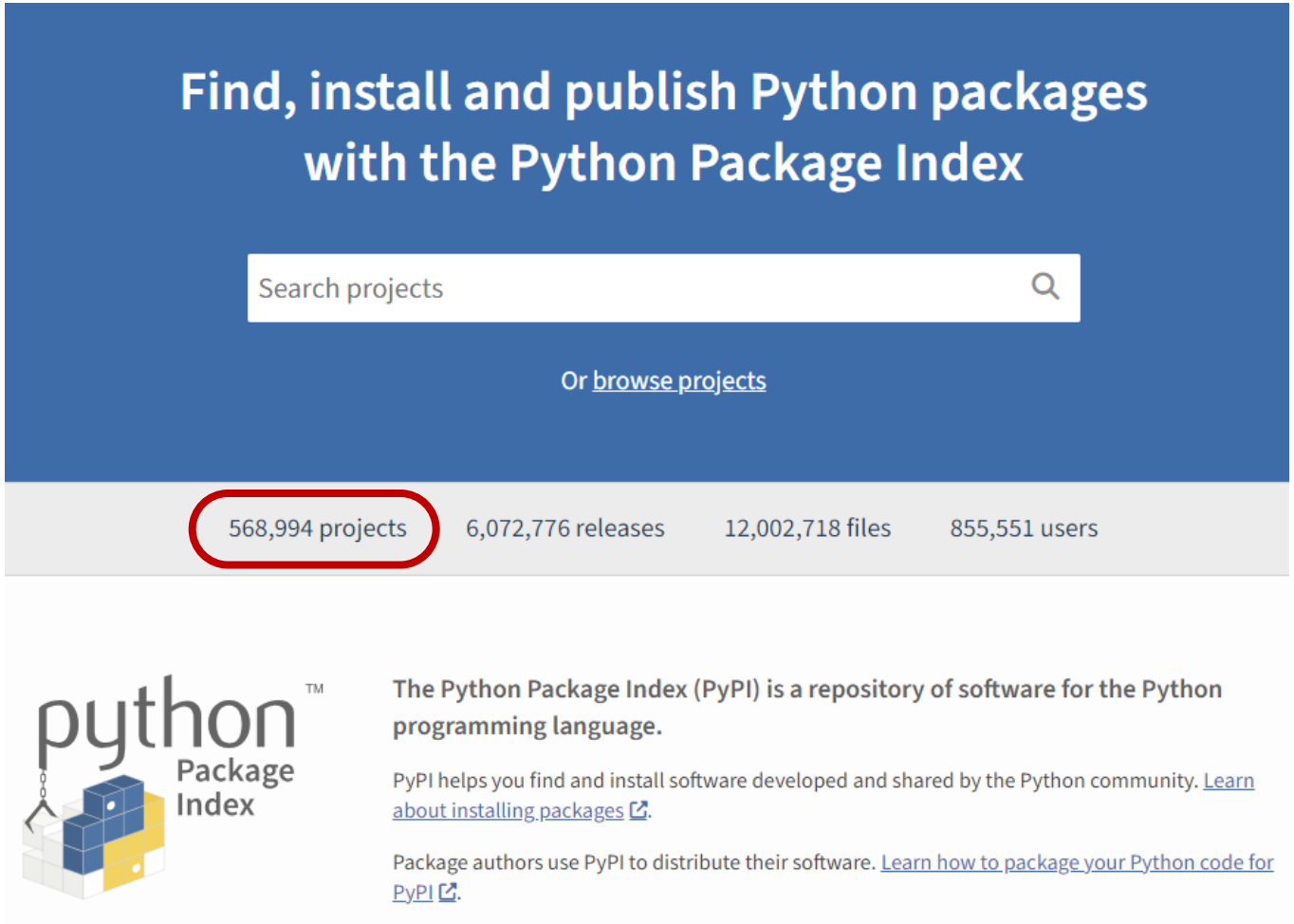
- PYPL (PopularitY of Programming Language)
  - Measure: The number of searches in Google (Google Trends; compared to a year ago)
  - **Python** is in the first place (on September 12th, 2024).

Rank	Change	Language	Share	Trend
1		**Python**	**29.66 %**	**+1.6 %**
2		Java	15.64 %	-0.2 %
3		JavaScript	8.3 %	-1.0 %
4		C#	6.64 %	-0.1 %
5		C/C++	6.46 %	-0.2 %
6	↑	R	4.66 %	+0.2 %
7	↓	PHP	4.35 %	-0.5 %
8		TypeScript	2.96 %	-0.0 %
9		Swift	2.69 %	+0.0 %
10	↑	Rust	2.65 %	+0.6 %

Image: PyPI (retrieved on June 24th, 2021)

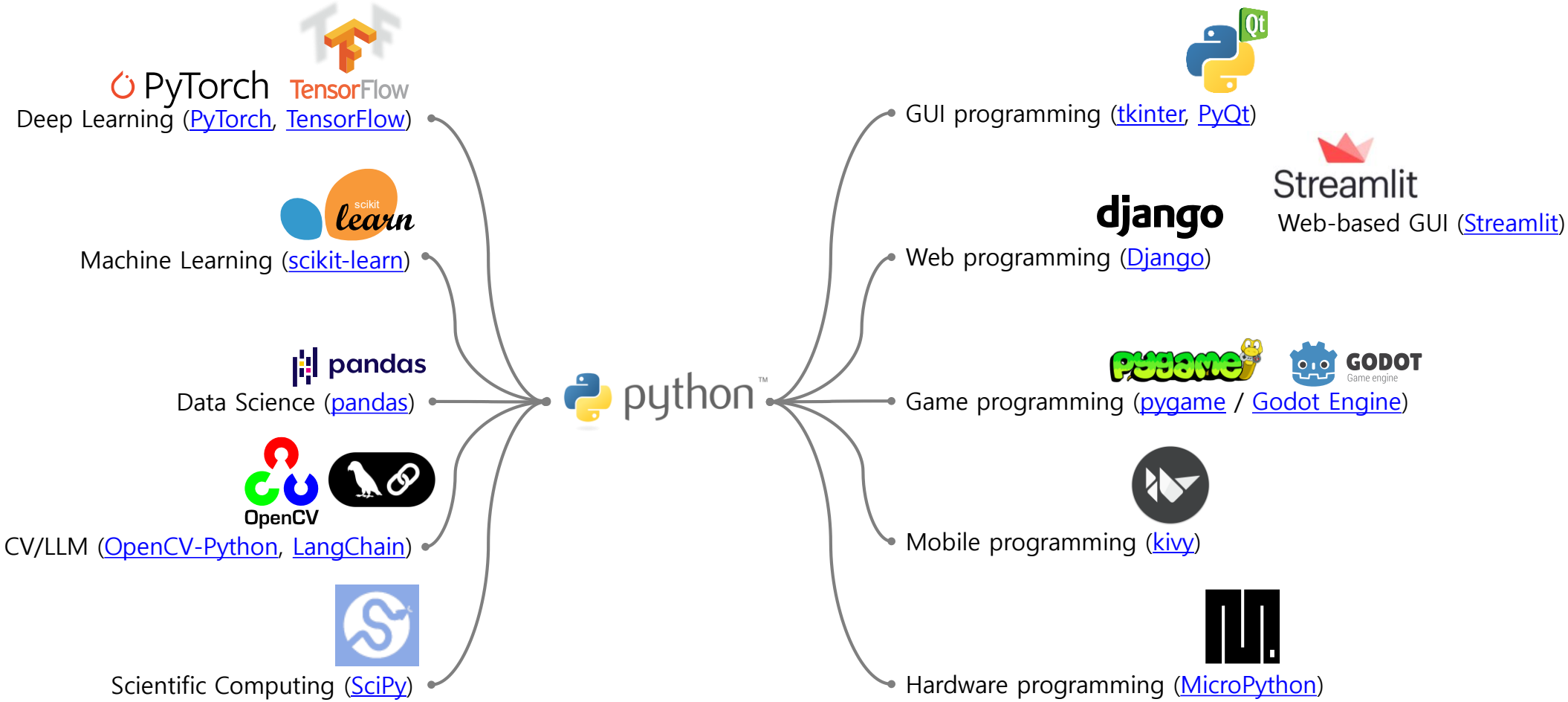
Why Python?

- PyPI (The Python Package Index)
  - There are 568,994 projects in Python package repository (on September 14th, 2024).
  - The packages can be easily installed by `pip` (the package installer for Python).



Why Python?

- What can I do with Python?
  - Almost everything you want, ~~except hardware programming (e.g. firmware) and mobile programming~~
  - Please visit Awesome Python (maintained by Vinta Chen).



What is Python?

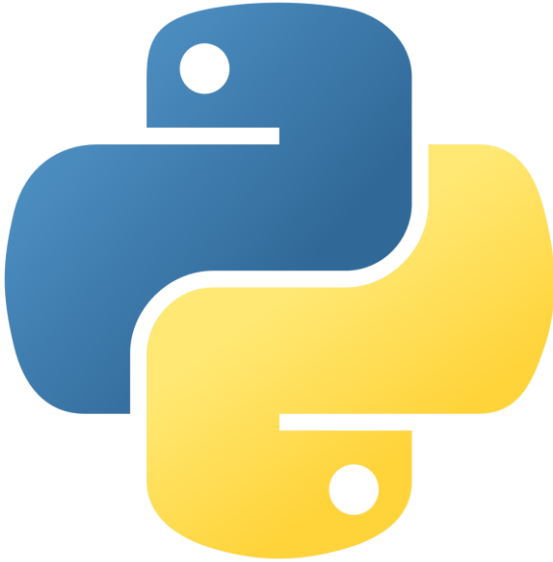
- **Python**
  - A family of snakes
  - A programming language by Guido van Rossum (first released in 1991)
    - Its name is derived from the British comedy group *Monty Python*.



Indian python



Monty Python



Python logo

Image: Wikipedia (Pythonidae, Monty Python)

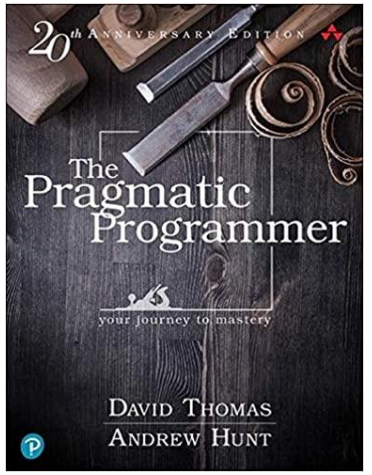
What is Python?

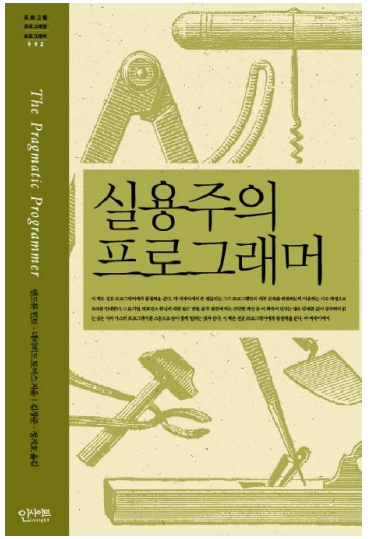
- **Python**
  - Python is an **interpreted**, high-level, general-purpose programming language. [Wikipedia]
    - **Dynamically-typed**, garbage-collected, and **batteries-included**
  - Python is a programming language that lets you work (easily and) quickly and integrate systems more effectively. [Official Homepage]
  - Design philosophy: **Code readability** [PEP 20 – The Zen of Python]
    - e.g. Block range: Curly-bracket `{ ... }` (C/C++, Java) vs. Indentation (Python)
    - e.g. `if` ... `else if` ... `else` ... (C/C++) vs. `if` ... `elif` ... `else` ... (Python)
  - History: v1.0 (1991), v2.0 (2000), v3.0 (2008; *not* completely backward-compatible)
    - Note) C (1972), Objective-C (1984), C++ (1985), R (1993), Java (1995), JavaScript (1995), PHP (1995), C# (2000)

- Online references: MINT Lab's Know-where
  - Please refer *Programming (Python)* category.

What is Python?

The Pragmatic Programmer





- The Zen of Python [PEP 20]

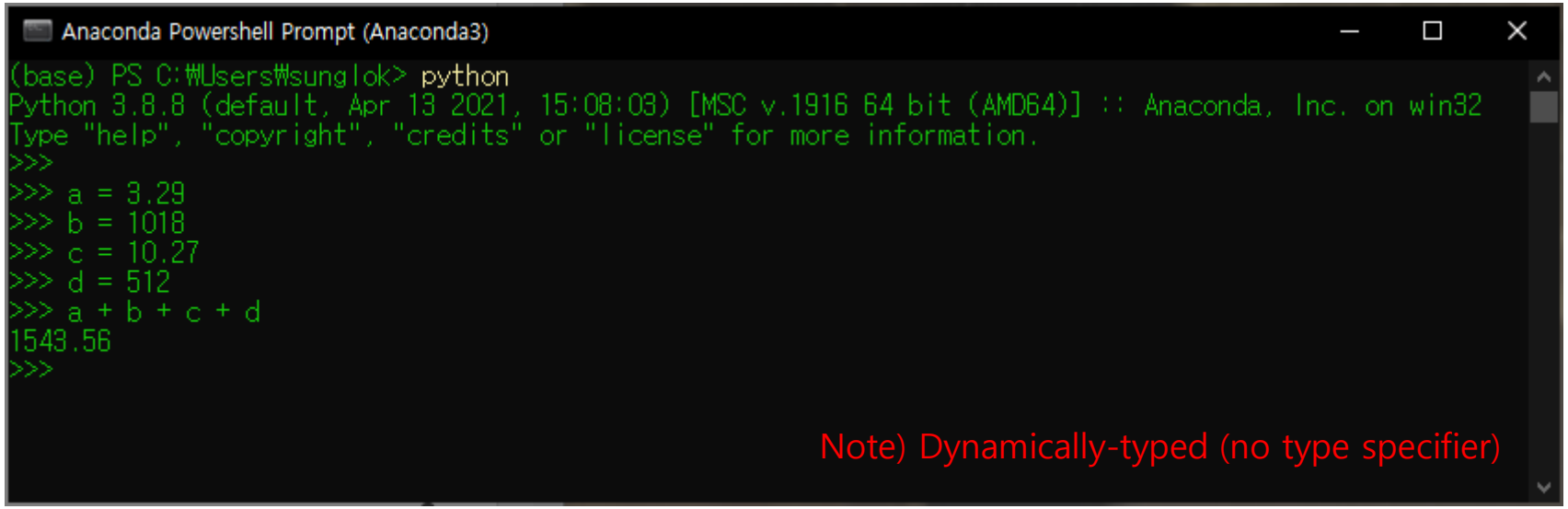
Beautiful is better than ugly.
Explicit is better than implicit.
Simple is better than complex.
Complex is better than complicated.
Flat is better than nested.
Sparse is better than dense.
Readability counts.
Special cases aren't special enough to break the rules.
Although practicality beats purity.
Errors should never pass silently.
Unless explicitly silenced.
In the face of ambiguity, refuse the temptation to guess.
There should be one-- and preferably only one --obvious way to do it.
Although that way may not be obvious at first unless you're Dutch.
Now is better than never.
Although never is often better than *right* now.
If the implementation is hard to explain, it's a bad idea.
If the implementation is easy to explain, it may be a good idea.
Namespaces are one honking great idea -- let's do more of those!

Image: Amazon and 교보문고

What is Python?

- Compiled language
  - A compiler translates machine code from source code.
  - e.g. C/C++, Java, C#, Objective-C, …
- **Interpreted language** (Note: script language)
  - An interpreter executes each line of source code step-by-step. (No pre-runtime translation)
  - e.g. **Python**, JavaScript, R, PHP, …

- How to use) Python console as a calculator



How to Use) Python on Your Computer

- I am using **Anaconda** (individual license) on Windows.
  - ~~I am using~~ Spyder IDE included in Anaconda. (Note: PyCharm, VS Code, Atom, …)

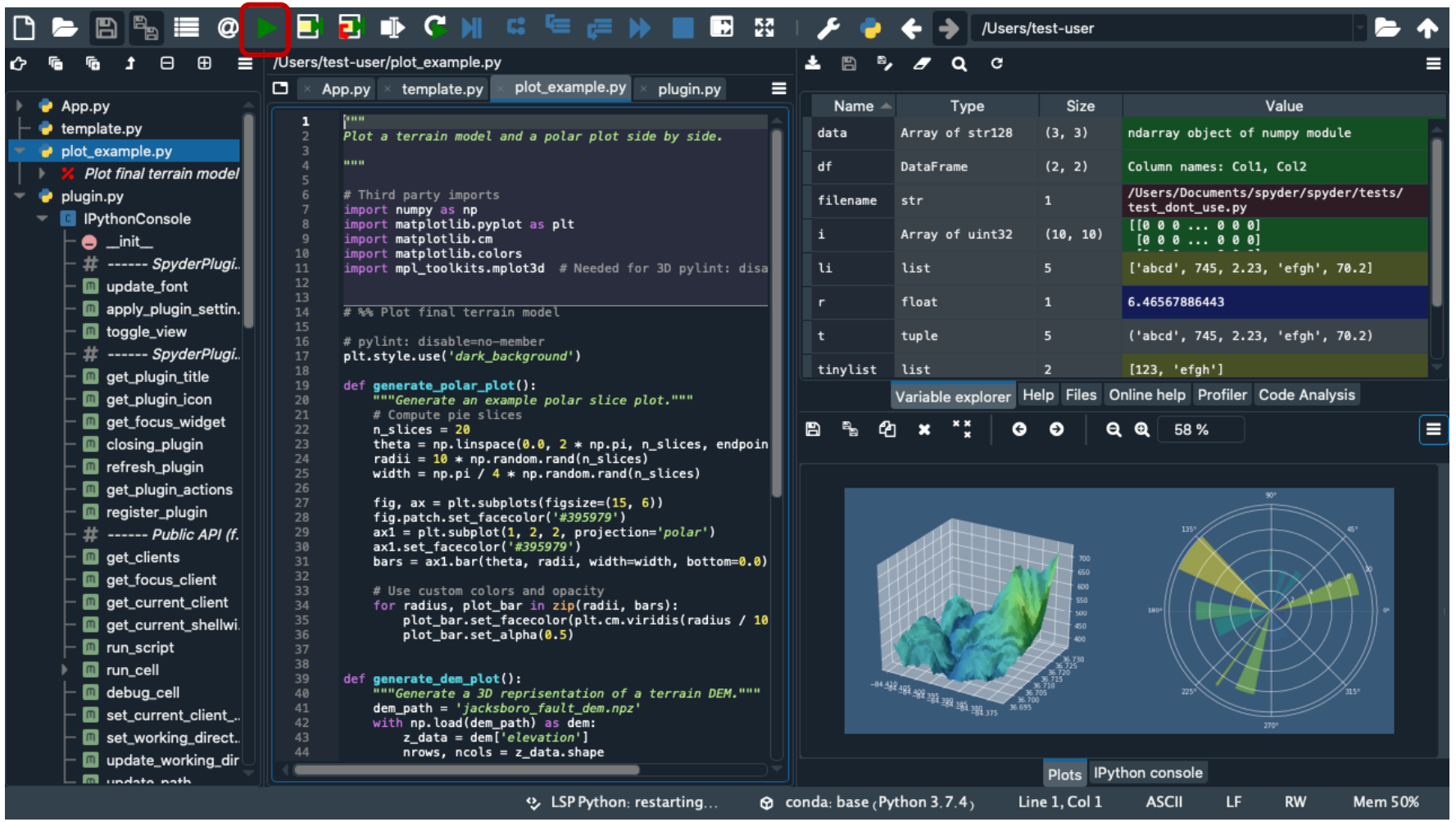


Image: Spyder IDE homepage.

How to Use) Python on Cloud

- I am using **Jupyter Notebook** on **Google Colab**.

  A web-based application that creates documents with live code, equations, and visualization

  + Zero configuration required
  + Free access to GPUs
  + Easy sharing

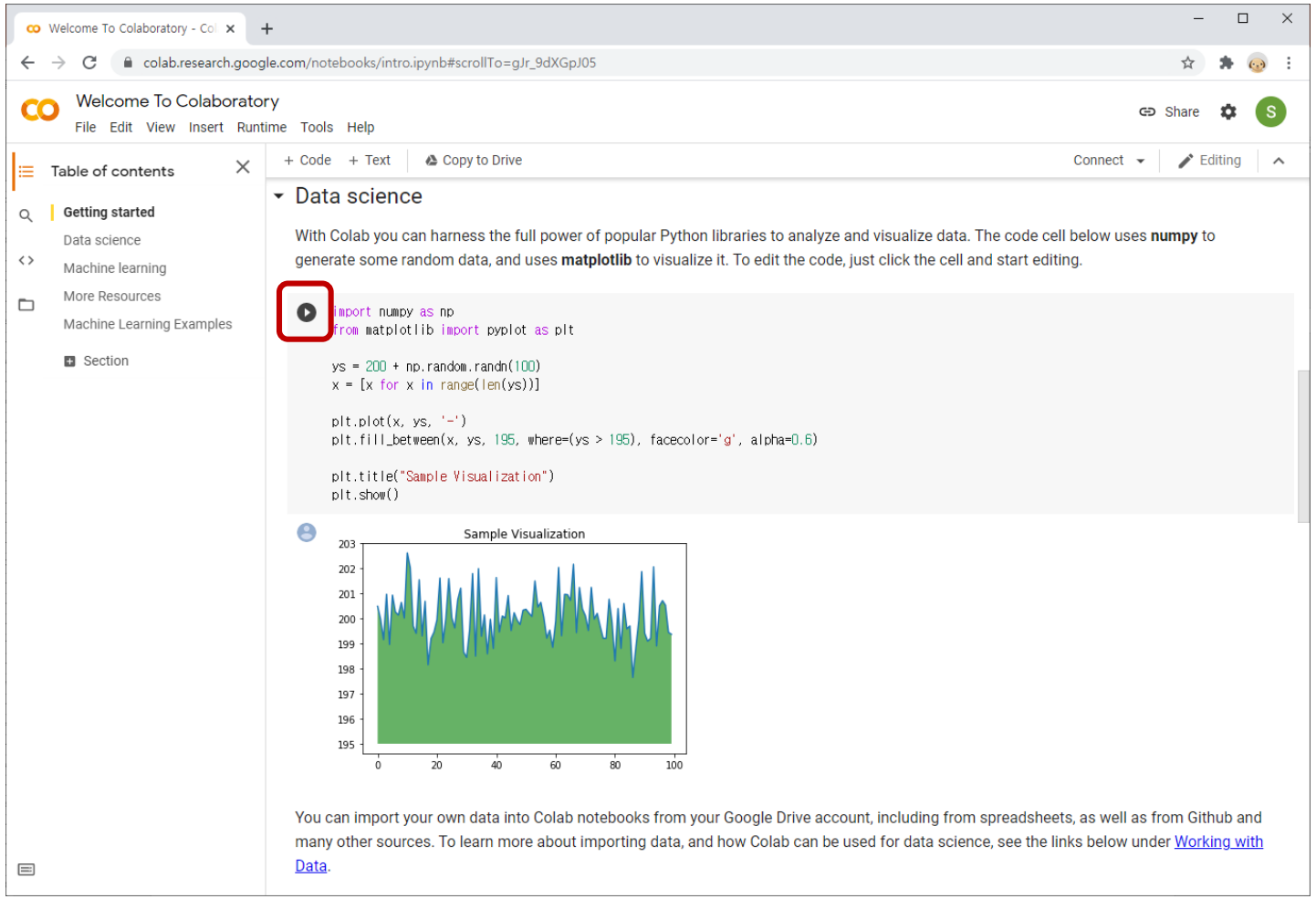


Table of Contents

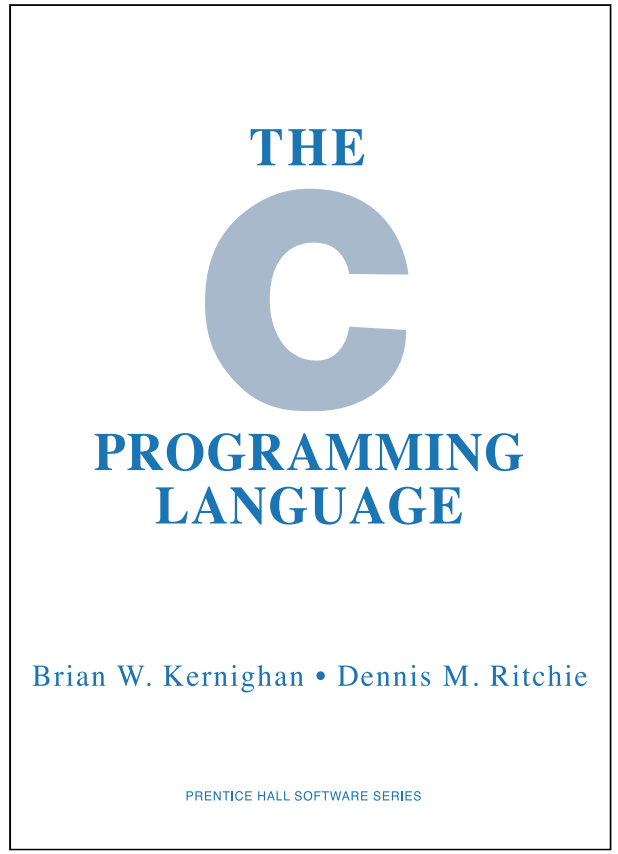
- **Why Python?**
  - Popularity (TIOBE, PYPL)
  - Versatility (*batteries-included*)
- **What is Python?**
  - Interpreted, dynamically-typed, high-level, and general-purpose programming language
  - Design philosophy: Code readability
- **How to Use Python**

- **Data Types**
- **Operators**
- **Flow Control**
- **Function Definition**
- **Object-oriented Programming**

Hello, World!

```
print('Hello, World!')
print(3.29) # Comment) Not necessary to think about data type
```

Note) `print` is available by default and it accepts any data type (~ `std::cout` in C++).



This lecture assumes that

you already meet "Hello, World!"

in other programming languages.

Image: Wikipedia

Data Types

- **Numbers**
  - **`int`**: Integers with an unlimited range

```
a = 329
```

  - **`float`**: Double-precision (64-bit) floating-point numbers

```
a = 3. # Same with 'a = 3.0'
b = 3.29
```

  - **`bool`**: Boolean values (`False` or `True`)

```
a = False
b = (3 == 3.) # Check this result
```

Note) Dynamically-typed → no type specifier

Data Types

- **String**
  - **`str`**: A text encoded in Unicode

```
name = 'Choi'            or   name = "Choi"
```

For multi-line text

```
name = 'Sunglok\nChoi'   or   name = """Sunglok
                              Choi""" # Also used for a block comment (~ /* ... */ in C++)
```

Note) String is a built-in type, not in a library (~ `std::string` in C++).

Data Types

- **Compound data**
  - **tuple**: Comma-separated arbitrary Python objects

```
prof_tuple = ('Choi', 327, True)  or  prof_tuple = 'Choi', 327, True
```

  - **list**: A list of arbitrary Python objects (~ std::array in C++)

```
prof_list = ['Choi', 327, True]
```

  - **set**: An unordered set of unique arbitrary objects (~ std::set in C++)

```
prof_set =  {'Choi', 327, True}
prof_set == {'Choi', True, 327}       # True (unordered)
prof_set == {'Choi', 327, True, True} # True (unique)
```

  - **dict**: A hash table of arbitrary values indexed by arbitrary keys (~ std::map in C++)

```
prof_dict = {'name': 'Choi', 'room_no': 327, 2021: True}
```

Note) The *compound* data can contain heterogeneous data types (not same with *arrays* with a homogeneous data type).

Data Types

- **Compound data**

Given)
```
prof_str   =  'Choi'
prof_tuple = ('Choi', 327, True)
prof_list  = ['Choi', 327, True]
prof_set   = {'Choi', 327, True}
prof_dict  = {'name': 'Choi', 'room_no': 327, 2021: True}
```

  - **Indexing**

```
prof_tuple[0] == 'Choi'
prof_list[-1] == True # Reverse indexing
prof_set[0]           # Error!
prof_dict['name'] == 'Choi'
prof_dict[2021] == True
```

  - **Slicing**

```
prof_str[1:3] == 'ho'
prof_str[1:] == 'hoi'
prof_str[1::2] == 'hi'
prof_list[::-1] == [True, 327, 'Choi']
```

Data Types

- **Compound data**

  Given)
```
prof_str   =  'Choi'
prof_tuple = ('Choi', 327, True)
prof_list  = ['Choi', 327, True]
prof_set   = {'Choi', 327, True}
prof_dict  = {'name': 'Choi', 'room_no': 327, 2021: True}
```

  – **Concatenation**: Merging two compounds

```
new_str  = prof_str  + ' Sunglok'
new_list = prof_list + ['Mirae Hall', 'SEOULTECH']
prof_set.union({327, 'Mirae Hall', 'SEOULTECH'})
prof_dict.update({'room_no': 109, 'building': 'Mirae Hall', 'school': 'SEOULTECH'})
```

  – **Appending**: Adding an item to a compound

```
prof_list.append('Mirae Hall')
prof_set.add('Mirae Hall')
prof_dict['building'] = 'Mirae Hall'
```

  Check) How about concatenation and appending for a **tuple**?

Data Types

- **Useful built-in functions**
  - **Type check**

```
type(prof_str) == str
```

  - **Type casting**

```
int(3.29) == 3
str(3) == '3'
int('29') == 29
```

    Note) The above two conversions are easier to use than C/C++/Java.

  - **Length of compound data**

```
len(prof_name) == 4 # The number of items
```

Operators

- **Operator precedence**

Operator Types	Operators	Description
Compound data (Parentheses)	`(expressions...)`, `[expressions...]`, `{key: value...}`, `{expressions...}`	Binding (tuple) / parenthesized expression, list, dictionary, set
Subscription	`x[index]`, `x[index:index]`, `x(arguments...)`, `x.attribute`	Indexing, slicing, call, attribute reference
Arithmetic (Bitwise)	`**`	Exponentiation
	`+x, -x, ~x`	Positive, negative, bitwise NOT
	`*, @,` `/, //, %`	Multiplication, matrix multiplication, division, floor division, remainder
	`+, -`	Addition and subtraction
Bitwise	`<<, >>`	Bitwise shifts
	`&`	Bitwise AND
	`^`	Bitwise XOR
	`|`	Bitwise OR

Membership Identity Comparison	`in, not in,`
	`is, is not,`
	`<, <=, >, >=, !=, ==`
		Membership tests,
		Identity tests,
		Comparisons

Logical	`not`	Boolean NOT
	`and`	Boolean AND
	`or`	Boolean OR
Ternary	`if - else`	Conditional expression
Lambda	`lambda`	Lambda expression
Assignment	`=, +=, -=, *=, /=`	Assignment expression

Operators

- **Arithmetic** operators

```
type(4 / 2) == float # Always 'float' type (not 'int' type)
(7.5 // 2) == 3      # Floor division (integer division; 'int' type)
(-7.5 // 2) == -4
(7.5 % 2) == 1.5     # Modulo (remainder)
(2 ** 4) == 16       # Exponentiation
```

Note) Please distinguish division (/; `float` type) and floor division (//; `int` type).

- **Logical** operators

```
 not 3.29 > 3  and  10.18 < 10 or 5.12 > 5  # Note) They are not '!', '&&', and '||'.
(not 3.29 > 3) and (10.18 < 10 or 5.12 > 5) # Check two results
```

- **Ternary** operators

```
x = 3
is_odd = True if x % 2 == 1 else False # In Python: Value1 – Condition – Value2
is_odd = (x % 2) == 1 ? 1 : 0;         // In C/C++: Condition – Value1 – Value2
```

Flow Control

- **Condition**: `if` statement, ~~`switch-case-break` statement~~ `match-case` statement (Python 3.10+)
- **Loop**: `for` statement, `while` statement
  - Loop control: `break`, `continue`, and `else` statements
- **No action**: `pass` statement (similar to `;` and `{ }` in C/C++)

- Example) Factorial (of a positive integer n)
  - The product of all positive integers less than or equal to n
  - $n! = n \cdot (n-1)! = n \cdot (n-1) \cdot (n-2) \cdot \cdots \cdot 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1$

```
n = 7      # The given integer
f = 1      # The result of factorial
if n < 0: # Note) No curly-bracket for a block
    pass
elif n == 0:
    pass
else:
    while n > 0:
        f = f * n
        n = n - 1
```

Flow Control

- **Condition**: `if` statement, ~~`switch-case-break` statement~~ `match-case` statement (Python 3.10+)
- **Loop**: `for` statement, `while` statement
  - Loop control: `break`, `continue`, and `else` statements
- **No action**: `pass` statement (similar to `;` and `{ }` in C/C++)

- Example) Prime number
  - A natural number ($n > 1$) that is not a product of two smaller natural numbers

```
n = 7 # The given integer
for x in range(2, n):
    if n % x == 0:
        print(n, 'equals', x, '*', n//x)
        break
else:
    print(n, 'is a prime number')
```

Flow Control

- **Loop**: `for` statements
  - `for` statements with **sequential data** (string, list, tuple, …)
    - You can loop with each index or each item (~ `std::iterator` in C++) or both.

```
year_list = [1982, 1984, 2014, 2016]
for idx in range(len(year_list)):                # Loop with indices
    print(idx)
for item in year_list:                           # Loop with items
    print(item)
for idx, item in enumerate(year_list):           # Loop with indices and items
    print(idx, item)
```

Function Definition

- **Function definition**
  - Example) Factorial (of a positive integer n)
    - The product of all positive integers less than or equal to n
    - $n! = n \cdot (n-1)! = n \cdot (n-1) \cdot (n-2) \cdot \cdots \cdot 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1$

```
def factorial_for(n):
    f = 1
    for m in range(1, n + 1):
        f *= m
    return f

def factorial_rec(n=1): # Default argument values
    if n <= 1:
        return 1
    else:
        return n * factorial_rec(n - 1)

factorial_for(10) # 3628800
factorial_rec(10) # 3628800
factorial_for()   # Error!
factorial_rec()   # 1
```

Function Definition

- **Multiple return values (as a tuple)**
  - Example) Mean and variance of data
    - Mean (a.k.a. average): $\mu = \mathrm{E}(X) = \frac{1}{n}(x_1 + x_2 + \cdots + x_n)$
    - Variance: $\mathrm{Var}(X) = \mathrm{E}\left((X - \mu)^2\right) = \mathrm{E}(X^2) - \mu^2$

```
def mean_var(data):
    n = len(data)
    if n > 0:
        mean = sum(data) / n
        sum2 = 0
        for datum in data:
            sum2 += datum**2
        var = sum2 / n - mean**2
        return mean, var
    return None, None

data = [3, 2, 9, 1, 0, 8, 7, 5 ]
pair = mean_var(data)        # pair = (4.375, 9.984)
mean, var = mean_var(data)   # mean = 4.375, var = 9.984
mean, _ = mean_var(data)     # Get only the first one
mean = mean_var(data)[0]     # Get only the first one
```

Object-oriented Programming



- **Class definition and object instantiation**
  - Example) Dice and coin

```
from random import randint

class Dice:
    def throw(self):
        return randint(1, 6)

dice = Dice()
print(dice.throw()) # [1, 6]
```

```
from random import randint

class Dice:
    def __init__(self, boundary=(1, 6)): # A constructor
        self.start = min(boundary)
        self.end = max(boundary)

    def throw(self):
        return randint(self.start, self.end)

dice = Dice()
print(dice.throw()) # [1, 6]

coin = Dice((0, 1))
print(coin.throw()) # 0 or 1
```

Image: Wikipedia

Summary

- **Why Python? What is Python? How to Use Python**
- **Data Types**
  - Dynamically-typed → Type specifiers are *optional*.
  - Built-in compound data types: `str`, `tuple`*, `list`*, `set`*, `dict`* (*support heterogeneous data types)
- **Operators**
  - More natural (e.g. `&&` → `and`, `condition ? A : B` → `A if condition else B`)
- **Flow Control**
  - Easier access to elements in compound data with `for` statement (similar to *iterators*)
- **Function Definition**
  - Multiple return values (as a `tuple`)
- **Object-oriented Programming**
  - Explicit: `self` must be explicitly stated. (`this` is implicit in C++ and Java)
  - Dynamically-typed → You can make member variables whenever you want.

    Note) Recommendation: Please make member variables in constructors (`__init__` function).